Lost Teen Found Safe After Six Days in the Woods

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A teenager lost in the Australian woods for six days is safe at home now.

William, 17, was found alive on Thursday next to a **creek** near Walhalla, a small town about 185 kilometres east of Melbourne. He had gone camping with a friend last Friday and got lost walking back for more gear.

A police **helicopter** crew saw him asleep on a flat rock by the **creek**. He woke up, gave a thumbs up, and was lifted up to safety. He wore no shirt and was **sunburned**, using towels as blankets.

Police said he was in good spirits and mostly in good health. He was taken to a hospital so doctors could keep an eye on him. His mother, Elizabeth, was overjoyed and joked that he was grounded for life.

William has Level 2 **autism**, which means he needs a lot of support. He walked for days over very steep ground and spent his last two days at the **creek**, about 2 kilometres from his campsite. More than 100 emergency workers and **volunteers** had joined the search.

Word Treasure

helicopter -- A helicopter is an aircraft with spinning blades on top that can fly up, down, and hover in one place.

creek -- A creek is a small stream of water that flows through the land.

sunburned -- Sunburned means your skin is red and sore from spending too long in strong sun.

autism -- Autism is a way a person's brain works differently, which can mean they need extra help in daily life.

volunteers -- Volunteers are people who choose to help without being paid to do it.

Background you need

When someone gets lost in the woods, police, emergency workers, and volunteers search the area to find them.

A helicopter crew can look for a missing person from the sky and help lift them to safety.

A person who has been lost outside may need to stay warm and be checked by doctors after they are found.

Break it down

WHO: William, a 17-year-old teenager, his mother Elizabeth, and the police helicopter crew and search workers.

WHAT: William was found alive after being lost in the woods for six days and was lifted to safety.

WHERE: Next to a creek near Walhalla, a small town about 185 kilometres east of Melbourne in Australia.

WHY: He got lost while walking back for more gear during a camping trip with a friend.

Why it matters

Learning what to do if you get lost outdoors, like staying in one place and staying warm, can help keep you safe.

Test what you remember

1. How many days was William lost in the woods?

- (A) Four days
- (B) Two days
- (C) Ten days
- (D) Six days

2. Where was William found?

- (A) On a road near his home
- (B) Asleep on a flat rock by a creek near Walhalla
- (C) At his campsite
- (D) In a hospital in Melbourne

3. Who first saw William?

- (A) His friend
- (B) His mother, Elizabeth
- (C) A police helicopter crew
- (D) A hospital doctor

4. What did William use as blankets?

- (A) A sleeping bag
- (B) Towels
- (C) Leaves from the woods
- (D) His friend's jacket

5. How far was the creek from William's campsite?

- (A) About 185 kilometres
- (B) About 10 kilometres
- (C) About 100 kilometres
- (D) About 2 kilometres

6. What did William's mother joke about?

- (A) That he needed a new tent
- (B) That he was grounded for life
- (C) That he had become a hero
- (D) That he should go camping again soon

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: C 4: B 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Police: Police said William was in good spirits and mostly in good health.**

2. **William's mother, Elizabeth: Elizabeth was overjoyed that William was safe and joked that he was grounded for life.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):